

Safe System of Work

Use of Loading Shovels

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Reviewed By: Name	Derick Bibby	Date of Review:	29.08.2025
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Record of Amendments			

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Overview

The following information provides guidance on the company's Safe System of Work for works involving the use of Loading Shovels.

All employees have a responsibility for their safety and the safety of others by adhering to these safety systems.

Hazards Identified

Use of a loading shovel could result in equipment overturning, people falling or collisions which can cause damage, crush injuries, electrocution, other serious injuries and can possibly be fatal.

- Adverse weather
- Crushing
- Cuts and abrasions
- Vehicle movements
- Falls from height
- Manual handling
- Slips & Trips

Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) Requirements



Risk Assessment

Risk	Controls
People and plant moving into the loading shovel's operating areas Visibility may be restricted for operators on larger machines Limited visibility if travelling with the bucket raised to high Risk of overturning on inclines soft and uneven surfaces. Refer to manufacturer's instructions Clothes snagged on controls prior to release of servo isolator / safety handle Controls can be caught inadvertently if near to safety lever Effect of weather on visibility and working / traffic surfaces Operator falling from the machine when mounting or dismounting.	Impose people exclusion area around plant and operation People accessing and alighting the machine must use the correct steps, have three points of contact and face the machine Safe and clean access into cab Safe and clean access for refueling and maintenance No entry into exclusion zone unless signaled by operator - Thumbs Up Automatic Braking Systems are available which stop the machine if obstruction detected

Operations

Operator

Shall be suitably trained and competent

Operators must hold a CPCS Card with category A21 along with the appropriate endorsement

Must have a current relevant driving licence (Category B), at least 18 years of age and be authorised if driving on the public highway

Highway' form to be completed prior to driving on public highway

A record of familiarisation training on particular model of plant must be kept

Full site-defined PPE required - close fitting PPE required in all cases to avoid catching on controls

Operator to be briefed on and to comply with all Client Pre-use, Daily and Weekly Defect Reporting Systems

Report defects and stop machine where defect is safety critical

Ensure machine is operated in accordance with manufactures instructions and in accordance with relevant training

Be briefed on the site Plant and Vehicle Management procedures and check for overhead obstructions and hazards

Shall stop work if any unauthorised / unsupervised personnel enter their immediate work area

Engine must be turned off if approached by others and keys removed from the ignition before leaving the plant unattended for any reason

Operator to mount and dismount machine using fixed access arrangements and always facing the machine

Seat belt must be worn

Shall report all unsafe conditions

All site speed limits must be briefed and complied with

Plant

Pre-use inspection signed off

If used on public highway - compliance with Construction and use regulations (lights, VED, registration plates front and rear etc.)

Current 12-month LOLER thorough examination certificate

Current 6-month LOLER certification for all on- board lifting tackle or handling attachments

Protected cab or FOPS cab structure where risk of falling objects

Seat belts (retractable) must be fitted and operational with green light to indicate when seat belt worn

Flashing amber beacon

Mirrors to provide 360° visibility

Inspection & Maintenance records available plus "next service due" date

Safe access for refueling and maintenance

Operating instructions must be available on the machine

All safety labels (decals) in place

Locking caps / covers to be in place

Isolation switch with key / locking doors with key

White reversing light and audible reversing alarm

Brake tests to be carried out and records available

Lifting duty chart displayed on boom or in cab

Articulation lock must be fitted and operational

Cab free of un-necessary items

Machine lifting points / tie down points must be clearly labelled and in good condition